

5.1 - Energy

Artificial Intelligence Policy

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S2026

Think:

- *How do we manage the massive energy demands of AI?*

Read:

- Chen, 2025. “[How much energy will AI really consume? The good, the bad, and the unknown](#)” *Nature*
- Stover, 2024. “[AI goes nuclear](#)” *The Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists*

Browse:

- Ars Technica, “[Can we make AI less power-hungry? These researchers are working on it.](#)”
- The Economist, “[How safe is nuclear energy?](#)”
- Mandler, 2024. “[Three Mile Island nuclear plant will reopen to power Microsoft data centers](#)”
- Erdenesanaa, 2024. “[A.I. Could Soon Need as Much Electricity as an Entire Country](#)” *NYTimes*
- Goldman Sachs, “[Is nuclear energy the answer to AI data centers’ power consumption?](#)”
- Bacquero, “[The Energy Footprint of Humans and Large Language Models](#)”

Additional Resources:

- de Vries, 2024. “[The growing energy footprint of artificial intelligence](#)” Joule.
- Crawford, 2022. *Atlas of AI: Power, Politics, and the Planetary Costs of Artificial Intelligence*. Yale.

Submit:

- Discussion question to course chat

 Tip

- “ Read”, “ Listen”, and/or “ Watch” items are required content for the day, and should be read/heard/watched before class on that day.
- “ Browse” items should be briefly looked at but do not need to be read deeply unless you want to
- “ Additional Resources” do not need to be looked at; they are there to serve, if useful, as further references for your debates, final projects, and general edification later.